Simone P. Barrett
638 East 21st Street, Apt. 4C
Brooklyn, NY 11210
[PHONE]

October 19, 2025

U.S. Citizenship and Immigration Services

Re: Marcia Evadne Whitfield, A-Number [A-NUMBER]
Form I-360, VAWA Self-Petition

DECLARATION OF SIMONE P. BARRETT

To the Officer reviewing this case:

¶ My name is Simone Patrice Barrett. I was born on June 2, 1980, in Kingston, Jamaica. I am a naturalized United States citizen. I live at 638 East 21st Street, Apartment 4C, Brooklyn, New York 11210. My telephone number is [PHONE]. I work as a medical billing specialist.

¶ I make this affidavit in support of the self-petition of my cousin, Marcia Evadne Whitfield. Everything I state here is based on my own personal knowledge, except where I say that Marcia told me something.

¶ Marcia and I are first cousins. Our mothers are sisters. We grew up spending every summer and holiday together in St. Catherine, and we have always been very close, more like sisters than cousins. Since Marcia came to New Jersey in 2018, we have talked on the phone almost every Sunday and visit each other several times a year.

¶ Marcia told me about Vernon soon after she started dating him in late 2021. I first met him when I visited Marcia for Christmas in December 2021. He was polite and charming, and Marcia was very happy. I attended their wedding at East Orange City Hall on July 15, 2022, and the dinner afterward. Marcia married Vernon because she loved him. She was excited about her future with him.

¶ For the first part of their marriage, Marcia seemed happy. When I called on Sundays, Vernon would sometimes get on the phone to say hello and joke with me.

¶ Things changed in 2024. In March 2024, Marcia told me that Vernon had lost his job and had lied to her about it for weeks. After that, I began to hear Vernon in the background during our Sunday calls, and what I heard was ugly.

¶ On many calls during the spring and summer of 2024, I heard Vernon shouting at Marcia. I heard him call her "stupid" and "useless" and use vulgar curse words at her that I

will not repeat here. More than once I heard him complain about her cooking and call her food "slop." One time I heard him tell her that no other man would ever want her. Marcia would go quiet or tell me she had to go.

¶ I remember one Sunday in the summer of 2024 when Vernon was yelling so loudly that I could hear every word even though Marcia was in another room. Marcia hung up on me. About an hour later she called me back, crying, and said she was sorry and that she was fine. I told her she was not fine and that she did not deserve to be spoken to that way.

¶ In August 2024, Marcia called me late at night, crying so hard I could barely understand her. She told me that she and Vernon had argued because he took $600 of the rent money from their account, and that he cursed at her and spat in her face. She said she had locked herself in the bathroom. I begged her to come stay with me in Brooklyn, but she said she could not leave her job.

¶ Over 2024 and early 2025, I watched my cousin change. She had always been lively, talkative, and full of jokes. She became quiet and nervous. She lost weight. She told me she could not sleep and that she had stopped going to church because she was ashamed. When I visited her in November 2024, at a time when Vernon was out of the apartment, she looked exhausted and much older than her age. She told me she was paying all the bills herself while Vernon slept all day.

¶ Marcia also told me that Vernon used her immigration case against her and said he could have her sent back to Jamaica. In April 2025 she told me that he did not go to her immigration interview, and then did not go to the rescheduled interview either.

¶ In May 2025, Marcia called to tell me that Vernon had moved out while she was at work and had taken money from their account. I went to stay with her that weekend because she was so upset. I encouraged her to talk to her doctor and to get counseling, and I am glad that she did.

¶ Marcia is a truthful, hardworking, and loving person. She did not deserve what Vernon did to her. I respectfully ask that her petition be approved.

I declare under penalty of perjury under the laws of the United States of America that the foregoing is true and correct to the best of my knowledge.

Respectfully,

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Simone Patrice Barrett
Dated: October 19, 2025, Brooklyn, New York